07-09 第1篇

# 阅读理解（议论文） Should Schools Give Students "Zero-Homework" Weekends Once a Month?

Ask a middle-school student what they dream of on Friday afternoon, and many will give the same answer: a weekend free from homework. In several cities, head teachers have begun a small experiment — **once every four weeks, a full weekend is declared "zero homework"**. No written tasks are given on that Friday. No quizzes on Monday. Just two full days for students to live as teenagers again. Is this a good idea? In my view, **a monthly "zero-homework" weekend is a wise policy that helps students, families, and even learning itself**.

The first reason is **rest**. Our bodies and minds are not made to run at full speed for months without a pause. In a recent survey of 2,000 students in our district, **71%** reported sleeping fewer than seven hours on a normal weekend because of homework. That is less than the eight to nine hours recommended by doctors for teenagers. When students spend one weekend a month free from written work, they catch up on sleep, and Monday mornings become noticeably brighter. Teachers often report that classes after a "zero-homework" weekend run more smoothly.

A second reason is **family**. In many homes, weekends have become a kind of silent library. Dad reads papers, Mum checks the shopping list, and the child disappears into a pile of homework. A free weekend, once in a while, pulls the family back together. Students cook with their parents, visit a grandparent, walk a dog, or simply watch the evening news together. Such small moments are not written on any test paper, but they build memory that lasts far beyond middle school.

Some people worry that a "zero-homework" weekend will make students lazy. This is an understandable fear, yet real cases suggest the opposite. In one pilot school, the teachers tracked grades for four months. After the rule began, monthly test **scores** went slightly up, not down. The teachers explained it in a single sentence: "Students worked harder during the other three weekends because they had something to look forward to." In other words, a small rest can actually make work sharper.

Others argue, "If homework is really good, why cancel it at all?" But homework is not the **enemy**. The question is not homework or no-homework; it is **balance**. Around 23 weekends a year still keep homework. A single "quiet weekend" each month is a small pause in a long piece of music, not a silence. Good musicians know that rests make the notes clearer.

Of course, "zero homework" must be designed carefully. It should mean no *written* tasks, but reading a storybook, taking a walk in the park, or helping with dinner are still encouraged. Teachers may also give an optional "challenge task" for students who truly want to work — optional, not **compulsory**. A weekend of free choice is not a wasted weekend. It is a weekend where growth takes a different shape.

In short, a once-a-month "zero-homework" weekend is a modern answer to an old problem. It rests the body, warms the family, sharpens the mind, and still keeps grades steady. If we can trust students with this small freedom, we may find that they give us back something larger: a happier, healthier classroom.

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**根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。**

**1. What is the writer's main opinion?**

A. All homework must be cancelled.
B. Students should study every weekend without rest.
C. A monthly "zero-homework" weekend helps students, families, and even learning itself.
D. Schools should give weekly homework contests.

**2. What did the recent district survey find about sleep?**

A. 71% of students sleep more than ten hours on normal weekends.
B. 71% of students sleep fewer than seven hours on a normal weekend because of homework.
C. All students sleep well every weekend.
D. No students enjoy weekends.

**3. In the pilot school, what happened to monthly test scores after the rule began?**

A. They fell a lot.
B. They slightly went up.
C. They stayed exactly the same.
D. They were not recorded.

**4. What does the writer mean by "the question is not homework or no-homework; it is balance"?**

A. Homework should never be given again.
B. Homework should be increased every week.
C. The key point is a reasonable rhythm between work and rest, not whether to have homework at all.
D. Homework should become an optional activity every day.

**5. How should the "zero-homework" weekend be designed?**

A. With compulsory tasks for every student.
B. With no written tasks, but with optional "challenge tasks" and encouragement to read, walk, or help at home.
C. Only for top students.
D. Only in winter months.

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# 答案与解析

**1.**
【答案】C
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】首段尾句
【解析】每月一次"零作业周末"有益身心与学习。A/B/D 均偏离。故选 C。

**2.**
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】"71% reported sleeping fewer than seven hours..."
【解析】71%周末睡眠不足 7 小时。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

**3.**
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】"scores went slightly up, not down"
【解析】成绩略升。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

**4.**
【答案】C
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】"it is balance"
【解析】关键在节奏平衡。A/B/D 均错。故选 C。

**5.**
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】"no written tasks... optional 'challenge task'..."
【解析】无书面+有可选挑战任务。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

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**词汇注释（超纲词）**

- **pilot** [adj.] 试点的
- **policy** [n.] 政策
- **enemy** [n.] 敌人

- **compulsory** [adj.] 必须的
- **rhythm** [n.] 节奏